

CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **August 20, 2026** — a catch-up cycle covering the Aug 16-20 gap (an Aug 17 draft and an Aug 18 draft were each written but never delivered; no cycle ran Aug 19). **Today's score set is a DRAFT, awaiting my manual stamp — see the note below.**

➤ **Draft — flagged for manual review, not auto-stamped.** Three of four qualitative pillars held flat; Iran War Risk re-rated down after the 60-day Hormuz MoU window lapsed and the UAE reported Iran fired ballistic missiles at its territory (Iran denies it) — the first direct attack on the UAE reported in this conflict, a genuinely novel widening. No window moved more than 8 points and no call-band flipped, but this novel escalation vector doesn't cleanly fit the routine daily-move pattern Alex's 2026-08-06 delegated auto-stamp authority covers, so it is left as a draft for manual review rather than auto-stamped. See the Master Report's "My Decision" section for the full rationale.

THE FINAL NUMBER · AUGUST 20, 2026 (DRAFT) · BTC \$71,882.92

+0.68 Mild Bull — same call band as Aug 16, even though Iran War Risk re-rated down and Bitcoin TA improved sharply

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale -10 to +10; horizon-weighted variant +1.22). Positive because the far windows outweigh the near ones — **not a buy-today signal**. It is a "the storm is priced, the recovery isn't" number. This cycle, two pillars moved for real and roughly offset: Iran War Risk fell on the lapsed Hormuz deadline and the UAE missile-attack report, while Bitcoin TA's computed pillar jumped as BTC surged 14.2% to \$71,882.92. CLARITY, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat after independent re-verification.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	-1.40	Mild Bear — unchanged call band; Iran's cut and TA's rally roughly cancel
3 months	-0.74	Mild Bear — the September FOMC still sits inside this window
6 months	+0.37	Neutral — CLARITY/Tokenization structural strength vs. Iran's drag
1 year	+2.07	Bull — all five pillars still positive
3 years	+3.09	Strong Bull — law + adoption + cycle + valuation

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The Mild Bull conclusion stays positive under every leave-one-out drop (+0.31 to +1.08); dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still rounds down to **Neutral**, unchanged from Aug 16. See the Master Report's Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf	The summary. The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf	The math pillar. 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs	The story pillars. CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → every draft through August 20).
4	reports/archive/ + prior-work/	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with <code>run.py blend --set NAME</code>), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal** = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$ (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (August 20 draft P's — Iran War Risk re-rated down, three pillars held flat)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	32	47	58	82	92	Held flat: Sept 15 2:15pm ET cloture vote unchanged; Sen. Gallego's Aug 20 remarks reaffirm, not worsen, the known ethics stalemate
Iran War Risk	16	24	38	54	76	Re-rated down: the 60-day Hormuz MoU window lapsed Aug 18; UAE reports Iran fired ballistic missiles at its territory (Iran denies it) and suspended economic ties
Tokenization (RWA)	52	60	66	74	85	Held flat: rwa.xyz total RWA value flat at \$38.07B; an Aug 17 SEC/White House meeting on tokenized-stock rules remains explicitly non-final
Fed & Macro	43	41	48	56	62	Held flat: the Aug 19 FOMC minutes showed a broader hawkish bloc, offset by CME FedWatch's September-hold odds rising to ~65% — two signals that roughly cancel
Bitcoin TA (quant)	45	43	52	67	70	Quant pillar refreshed on today's price (BTC \$71,882.92, +14.2% vs. Aug 16) — weekly composite flipped from bearish to Neutral, price moved to +11.9% above the 200-week average

P values shown (50 = coin flip). Iran War Risk moved on real evidence; Bitcoin TA moved on the computed tape read; CLARITY, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat after independent re-verification.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status:** August 20 scores — a catch-up cycle covering the Aug 16-20 gap (an Aug 17 draft and an Aug 18 draft were each written but never delivered; no cycle ran Aug 19) — are left as a **DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review**, not auto-stamped. No pillar's P moved more than 8 points and no FINAL NUMBER call-band flipped, but Iran War Risk's evidence includes a genuinely novel escalation (a state, the UAE, reportedly targeted directly for the first time, with attribution disputed) that doesn't cleanly fit the routine pattern Alex's standing delegated daily authority (in effect since 2026-08-06) is meant to cover — per the runbook's own guidance to default to draft when a situation is genuinely novel or ambiguous. Every report prints the full lineage (June committed → every draft through August 20, still awaiting stamp). Nothing hides its history.
- **Verification:** facts researched with primary/wire-source discipline, independently fact-checked, and the whole package forensically audited; score math recomputed independently; price data cross-checked across two exchanges; models that failed out-of-sample testing were excluded and say so. This cycle's checks: independently re-verified the Aug 18 draft's claims (Hormuz MoU lapse, Oman threat, Strait traffic collapse, Brent range) against CBS/CNN primary coverage; found and verified the UAE missile-attack report (Bloomberg, CNN, CP24) and Iran's denial; read the FOMC minutes directly from federalreserve.gov; pulled rwa.xyz's total RWA figure directly and caught a mis-scraped Treasuries subtotal before it could be used; reconfirmed the CLARITY Sept 15 cloture date and the ethics-proposal stalemate.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles, a disclosed fragility this report has repeatedly flagged; the TA pillar caps its own conviction at $P = 50 \pm 25$; single-source items are labeled in-line (e.g. an unconfirmed FT report on Iran targeting US assets in Europe, explicitly not used to move any score); current chart bars are partial and the completed-bar numbers are printed; the Robustness section shows dropping CLARITY or Tokenization still lands at the Neutral/Mild-Bull boundary, unchanged from Aug 16.
- **The near-term calendar is the test:** jobless claims and Fed H.4.1, both due Aug 20 (today) and unconfirmed as of this run · the GENIUS Act joint CIP comment period closing Aug 21 · the first CLARITY cloture vote, precisely dated 2:15pm ET Sept 15 · an actual signed, operating Hormuz agreement the US accepts, or independent confirmation/refutation of the UAE missile-attack report · next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot), week of Sept 15 · GENIUS Act 18-month backstop effective Jan 18, 2027. Each pillar's trigger table says in advance what each outcome does to the scores.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check the trigger tables: they are the falsifiable part.